

Lockheed Model 10 Electra



STYLISH INTERIOR

The interior of the Lockheed 10 was small but stylish. Heating, comfortable seats, and sound insulation made it luxurious by the standards of the day.

DATING FROM 1934, THE LOCKHEED Model 10 Electra belonged to the same ground-breaking generation of airliners as the Boeing 247 and the Douglas DC-2 and DC-3 – twin-engined, all-metal, stressed-skin monoplanes incorporating the latest features to reduce drag, including retractable undercarriages. They could all fly passengers further and faster than their predecessors, but the Electra was the fastest and

most stylish of the set. The Electra design team was headed by Hal Hibberd, although the distinctive double tail was down to a junior designer, Kelly Johnson, who had a great career ahead of him at Lockheed. They produced an aircraft that could carry ten passengers plus mail or freight, at an average speed of around 190mph (305kph). Although the DC-3 won the lion's share of the market because it could carry more passengers,

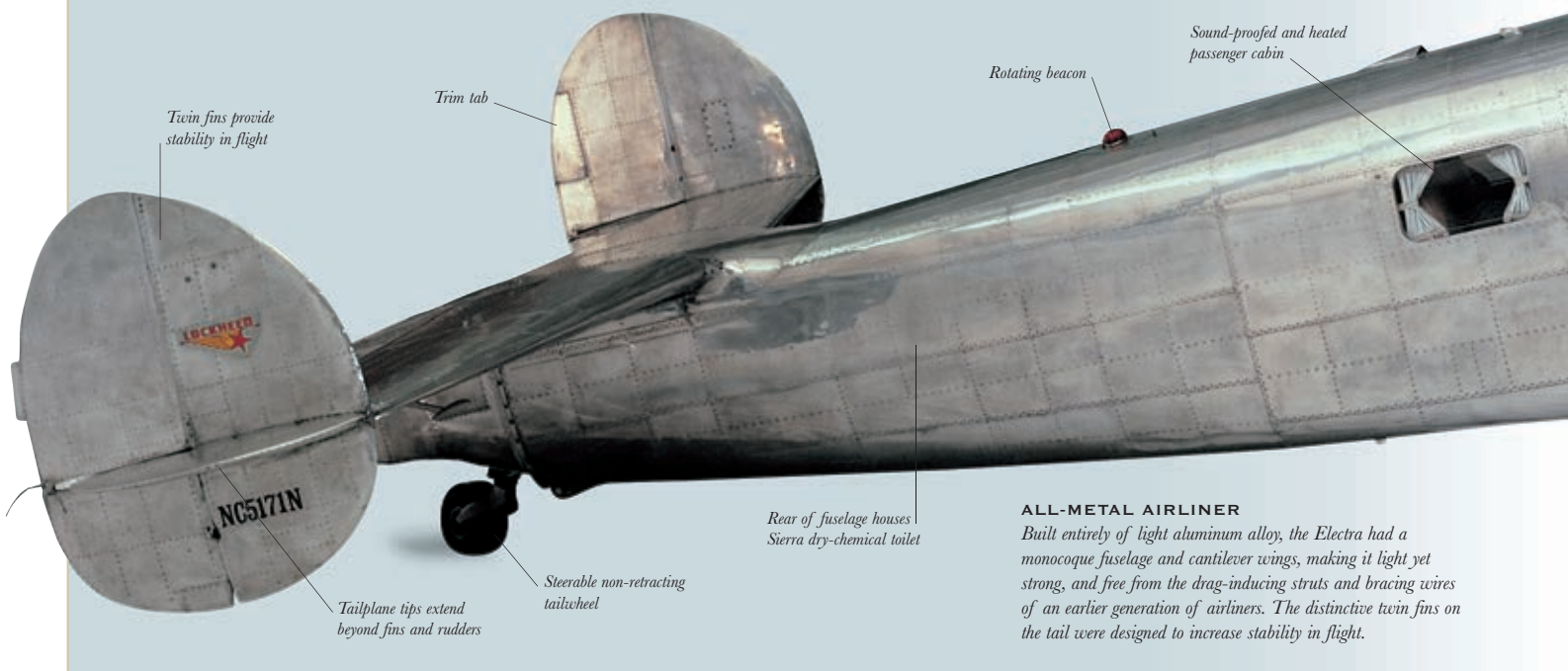


MAIL RUNNER

British Airways was one of the first foreign companies that bought Electras. This aircraft is serving as an airmail carrier, a suitable use for an aircraft that was fast but relatively low on payload. A British Airways Electra carried Prime Minister Neville Chamberlain to negotiate a flawed peace deal with Nazi dictator Adolf Hitler, at Munich in 1938.

the Electra pulled in sufficient orders from major US and foreign airlines to rescue the Lockheed company from potential bankruptcy. In all, 149 Model 10s were built.

The subsequent Model 14 Super Electra (shown above left), introduced in 1937, could cruise at a remarkable 190mph (300kph). In 1938, the eccentric millionaire Howard Hughes piloted one around the world in under four days.



ALL-METAL AIRLINER

Built entirely of light aluminum alloy, the Electra had a monocoque fuselage and cantilever wings, making it light yet strong, and free from the drag-inducing struts and bracing wires of an earlier generation of airliners. The distinctive twin fins on the tail were designed to increase stability in flight.